**SUBJECT: Library Reference and Research Services**

## RELATED DOCUMENTS

*Standards for Licensure and Accreditation*, Commission for Academic Accreditation, Ministry of Education, United Arab Emirates--Learning Resources (Standard 6.1); LIB 8500 Access to University Libraries and Student Success Centers.

## SECTION 1 POLICY STATEMENT

1.1. The university libraries provide reference and research services through its professional librarians. It provides access to and assistance with databases, print publications, and electronic resources, and supplies required research materials.

## SECTION 2 SCOPE AND APPLICABILITY

2.1. This policy document is applicable to all library and student success center locations and to all students and employees of KU.

## SECTION 3 PURPOSE

3.1. This policy document describes the form and level of reference services offered to Khalifa University of Science and Technology students in all levels, faculty, staff and other users.

## SECTION 4 DEFINITIONS

The following definition(s) apply to this policy document:

4.1. **Alumna/Alumni:** A female/male individual who holds an undergraduate or graduate degree from the Khalifa University of Science and Technology, the Petroleum Institute, Masdar Institute, or KUSTAR.

4.2. **Reference Collection:** A specialized selection of materials used to find information or do research. Reference collections contain many sources of information, such as dictionaries, directories, almanacs, encyclopedias, atlases, and statistical compilations. They may also have bibliographies, indexes, and abstracts. Reference materials do not leave the library.

4.3. **Reference and Research Services:** Reference and research services include consultations in which librarians recommend, interpret, evaluate, and/or use information resources to help others to meet particular information needs. Each library has a location where patrons may receive assistance in using the library and receive answers to questions.

4.4. **Users:** Users are KU faculty, staff, students, or alumni.

4.5. **Visitors:** Any person who is not in any of the previous categories of users but is physically present, for whatever reason (training, tour, etc.), at a library branch.



The online version of this policy document is definitive.

## SECTION 5 PROVISIONS AND GUIDELINES

5.1. *General Provisions and Guidelines*

5.1.1. Reference and research services serve the information needs of all KU users.

5.1.2. Librarians exhibit model reference behavior at all times.

5.2. *Reference Questions Guidelines*

5.2.1. Reference and research enquiries are answered promptly and in a timely fashion to meet the information needs of users.

5.2.2. Rush information enquiries are prioritized.

5.2.3. Reference librarians should not give medical, legal, patent, or financial advice.

5.2.4. Reference librarians should not give personal judgements or critical interpretations.

5.3. *Reference Desk Guidelines*

5.3.1. Reference staff provide service at all locations.

5.3.2. Telephones at the reference and information desks are for official library use only; personal calls are not allowed.

5.4. *Reference and Research Services*

Reference and Research Services include the following:

5.4.1. Library orientation or individual tours;

5.4.2. Information on all library resources, print and electronic; basic information on the library online catalog; and the location of materials available; and

5.4.3. Information and instruction on the use of library equipment, as well as internet instruction and use of library computers.

5.5. *Reference and Research Statistics*

5.5.1. All locations should keep daily statistics on enquiries and questions asked.

5.5.2. Librarians regularly network with other academic institutions to exchange experiences in order to ensure the highest quality of reference and research services.

## SECTION 6 RESPONSIBILITIES

6.1. The SVP Academic and Student Services is responsible for the implementation of this policy document and its provisions.

6.2. The library management has monitoring authority.

## SECTION 7 REVIEW STATEMENT

7.1. This policy document is reviewed once every four (4) years, or more frequently at the request of the SVP Academic and Student Services or subsequent to changes in governing documents.

## SECTION 8 APPROVAL AUTHORITY AND REVISION HISTORY

**This policy document has been approved by the Khalifa University of Science and Technology's Board of Trustees. Original documentation is on file in the Office of the President. The online version is definitive.**

*First disseminated by the Office of the SVP Academic and Student Services on* 27 August 2017
*Most Recent Review:* 27 August 2017
*Revision History:*

| Revision No. | Effective Date | Description |
|---|---|---|
| 2 | | |
| 1 | | |
| 0 | 27 August 2017 | Policy document first adopted. |

*Next scheduled review:* 27 August 2021

END OF DOCUMENT